agencies. Vijayan sought to bail himself out by saying that IB officers asked him to go out of the room and, therefore, he had to keep out.

The CBI report, signed by deputy superintendent R S Dhankar and submitted to the Chief Judicial Magistrate, Ernakulam, wound up thus: To sum up, in view of the evidence on record, oral as well as documentary, as discussed above, the allegations of espionage are not proved and have been found to be false. It is, therefore, prayed that the report may kindly be accepted and the accused be discharged and permission be accorded to return the seized documents to the concerned.

That was not the last word from the CBI. The central investigating agency submitted two confidential reports, one each to the union government and the Kerala Government, detailing the falsehoods and pointing fingers at officers of the Kerala Police and the IB.

CBI REPORT ON THE ROLE OF IB OFFICERS

This report makes it clear at least two facts: one, the IB officers threatened and tortured the accused to extract statements, which turned out to be contradictory. Two, the Kerala Police were either kept in the dark or the state force, at this point of time, wanted to wash their hands off and blame the IB for trying to foist the spy case.

Analysing the ‘unofficial’ (UO) notes of the IB, the CBI report said: ‘It is crystal clear that the DIB first issued UO notes to the highest functionaries in the Government of India indicating involvement of Raman Srivastava, Ravinder Reddy and others and subsequently negated its own version given in the earlier notes.’

The CBI investigation found that Ravinder Reddy had no business links with the then Prime Minister P V Narasimha Rao’s son Prabhakar Rao. ‘Despite the above, the DIB sent several UO notes referred to the above mentioned important functionaries, little realising that those notes from the Director, IB, would be treated as authentic and having been sent after